

CreatorSpace

Creative Portfolio Website

CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT | TASK 5

A dynamic portfolio platform for presenting creative projects and ideas, built with PHP and MySQL.

Live website	https://creatorspace.infy.click
Source repository	github.com/Pavan-1080/creatorspace
Report date	9 October 2026

Prepared as the final capstone project report, documenting the application's purpose, architecture, database design, interface, and deployment.

1. Project Overview

CreatorSpace is a web-based creative portfolio concept intended to bring projects, experiments, and ideas together in one simple, browsable site.

Project purpose

The project is a full-stack web application built with a PHP server-side layer and a MySQL relational database. Public pages present the portfolio and project cards, while account, email-verification, dashboard, and administrative modules are included in the application codebase.

Objectives

- Build a responsive, branded portfolio interface for desktop and smaller screens.
- Store project and account data in a relational database instead of relying only on static markup.
- Provide account creation and email-verification flow, session-based login, and role-aware admin access.
- Support project browsing through category controls and search controls.
- Document the data model and interface flow for review and handover.

Main modules

Module	Purpose
Public portfolio	Homepage hero section, featured projects, and site navigation.
Project catalogue	Displays project records with search and category-filter controls.
Authentication	Login form and registration flow with hashed passwords and OTP verification logic.
User dashboard	Signed-in user landing page with project and account summaries.
Admin area	Role-protected project management and category analytics using Chart.js.
Supporting data	Database tables for articles, OTP records, projects, users, and contact messages.

Project deliverables

CreatorSpace brings together a public portfolio, database-backed project catalogue, account and verification components, user dashboard, administrator module, database documentation, and a deployed website.

2. Technology and Architecture

A straightforward PHP/MySQL architecture is used so the project can run on conventional PHP hosting.

Technology stack

Technology	Role in the project
PHP	Server-side page rendering, form handling, sessions, and database operations.
MySQL	Persistent storage for accounts, verification OTPs, projects, articles, and contact messages.
HTML5 + CSS3	Page structure, responsive layout, navigation, cards, and forms.
JavaScript / AJAX	Client-side interactions for project search and filtering.
PHPMailer / SMTP	Email delivery component used by the OTP verification workflow.
Chart.js	Admin analytics visualisation in the project codebase.
Composer	PHP dependency metadata through composer.json and composer.lock.

Request and data flow

1. Browser Visitor opens a public page or submits a form.	2. PHP pages Pages validate inputs, manage sessions, and call reusable database code.	3. Database layer db.php establishes the MySQL connection and shared character set.	4. MySQL Queries read or update persistent records.
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Authentication sequence

- Registration code validates the submitted name, email, and minimum password length.
- The password is hashed before storage. The registration flow creates a six-digit OTP, stores its hash and expiry, and calls the email-sending component.
- The OTP validity window in the registration code is 10 minutes; verification is handled by verify-otp.php.
- Administrative functionality checks the signed-in user role before exposing admin operations.

Deployment note

The online database was created on InfinityFree and the local SQL export was imported into it. Hosted PHP files must use the hosting database hostname, database name, username, and private password; credentials should never be committed to the public repository.

3. Database Design

The MySQL schema separates account data, verification state, project content, articles, and contact messages.

Table	Key fields / purpose	Relationships
users	id, name, email (unique), password hash, role, email_verified_at, created_at	Parent for OTP records and optional creators of projects/articles.
otp_verifications	id, user_id, otp_hash, purpose, expires_at, created_at	Foreign key user_id to users.id; deletes cascade with the user.
projects	id, title, category, description, image_url, project_url, created_by	created_by references users.id; set to NULL if the user is deleted.
articles	id, title, category, excerpt, content, published, created_by	created_by references users.id; set to NULL if the user is deleted.
contact_messages	id, name, email, subject, message, created_at	Stores contact/inquiry records independently.

Relationships and integrity

- One user can have multiple OTP verification records over time; each OTP record belongs to a user.
- Projects and articles may be associated with a creator. Their creator reference is nullable so content can remain if a user is removed.
- Unique and supporting indexes are used for frequent lookup fields such as user email, project title/category, article title/category/publication state, and OTP user/purpose.

Security measures present in the code

- password_hash() is used for user password storage.
- Prepared statements with bound parameters are used for key database operations to reduce SQL-injection risk.
- OTP values are stored as hashes and expiry timestamps rather than as plain-text codes.
- Role checks are implemented for access to administrative functionality.

Data note

The hosted database was imported from the local CreatorSpace SQL export. The live Projects screenshot displays two records: SWIGGY and BLOG POST. The report does not include or expose any credentials.

4. Interface Evidence - Homepage

The following images were provided from the live CreatorSpace site on 9 October 2026. Images are reproduced as supplied, with captions for context.

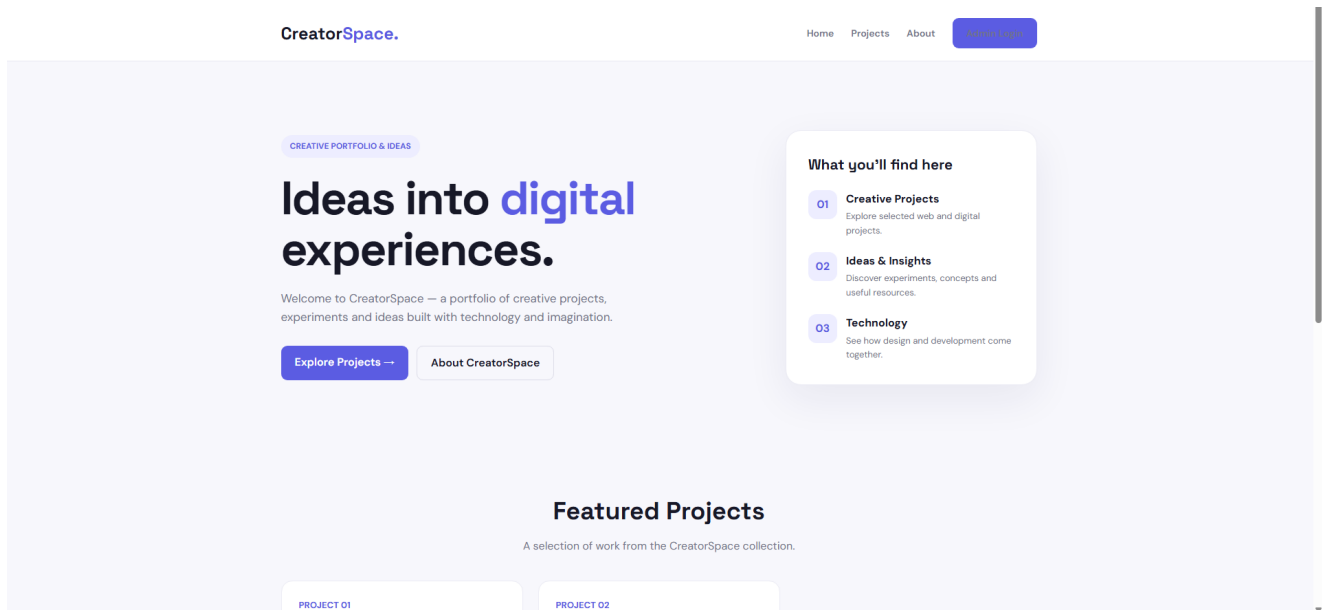


Figure 1. Homepage hero, navigation, portfolio introduction, and featured-project section.

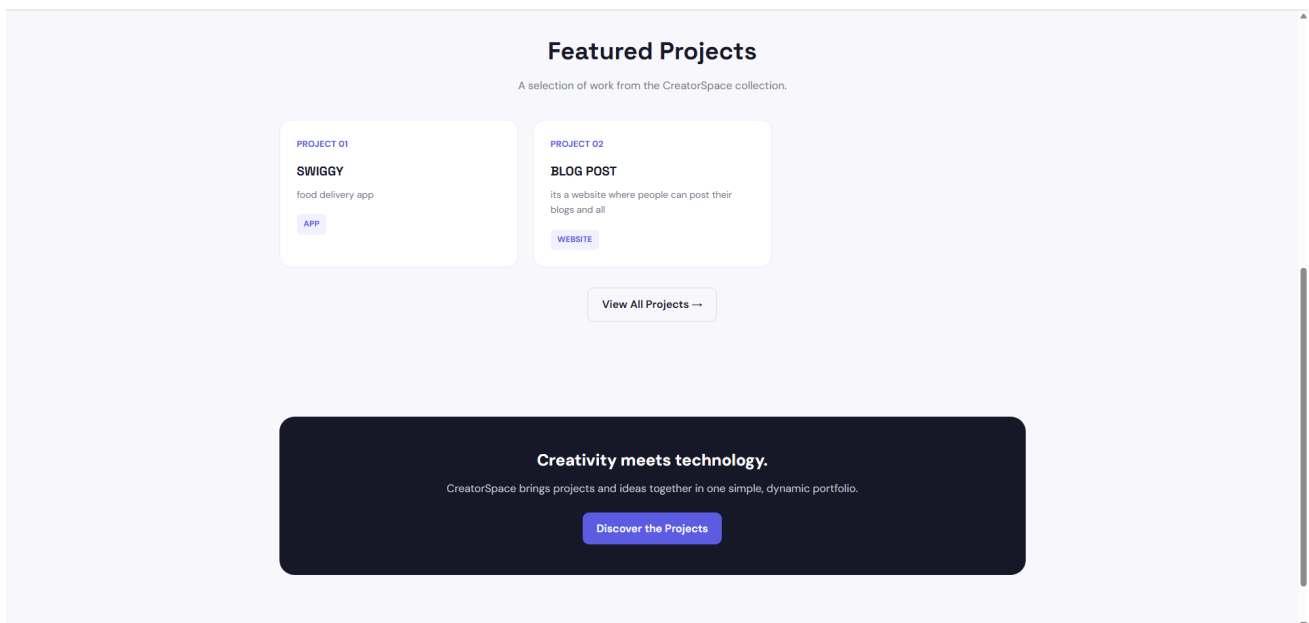


Figure 2. Featured-project cards and the closing call-to-action area.

5. Interface Evidence - Projects and Login

The following screenshots illustrate the live projects catalogue and login interface, including the visible search field and category selector.

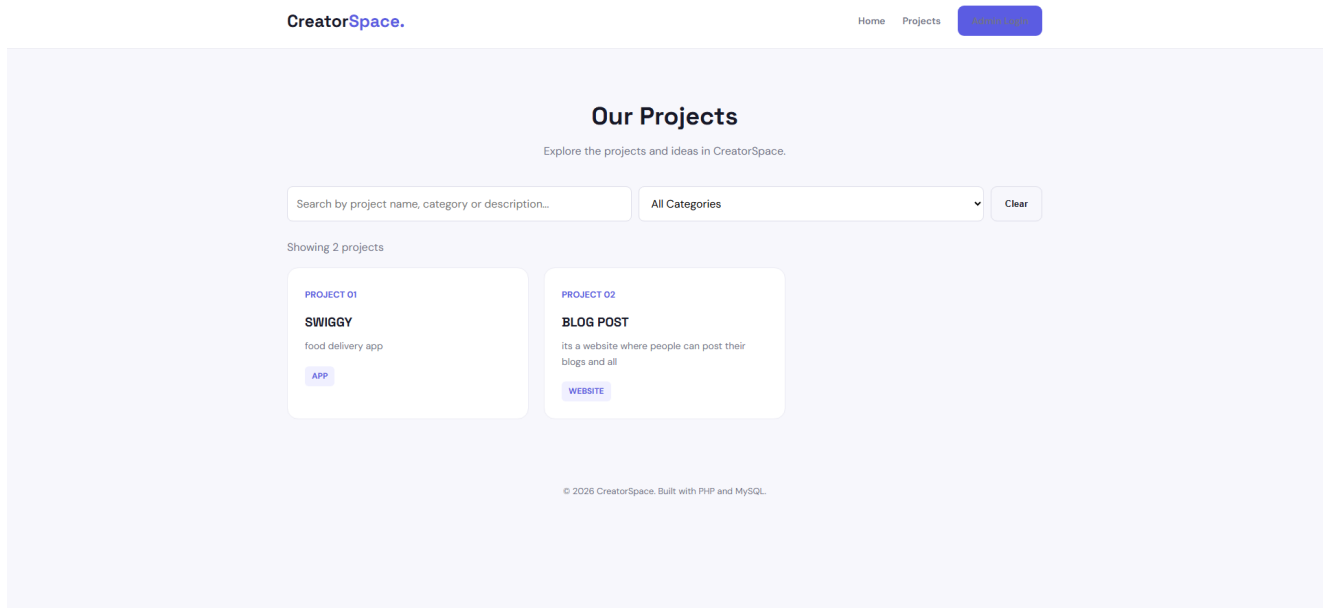


Figure 3. Projects catalogue showing two project cards, a search field, and category selector.

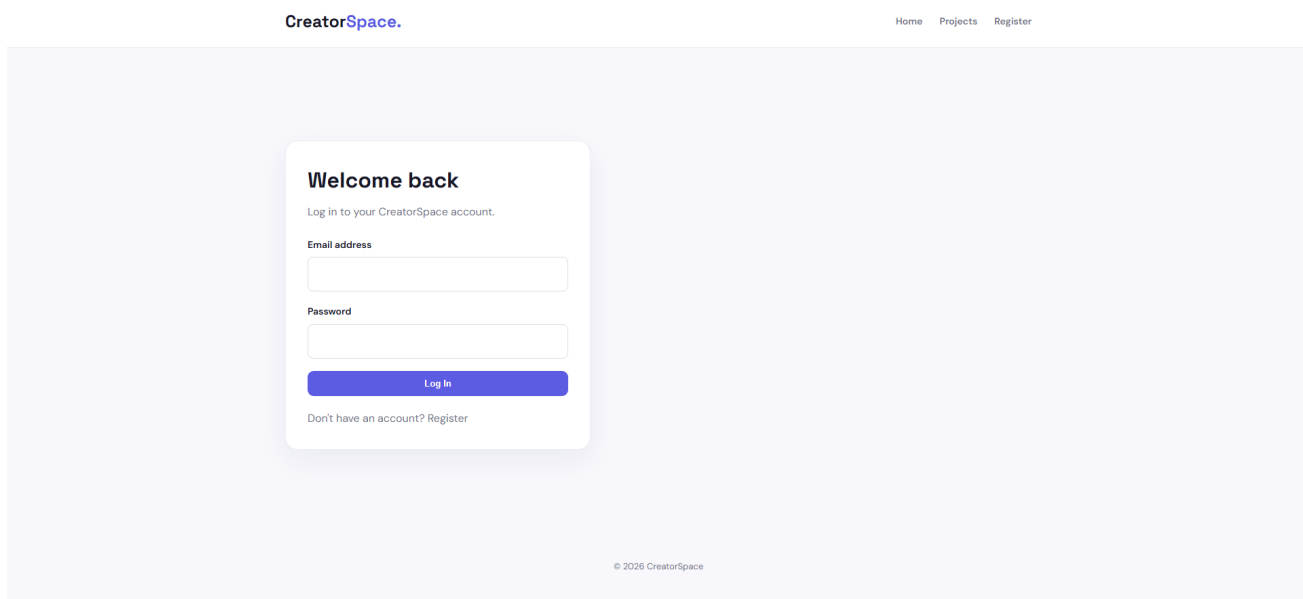


Figure 4. Login form with email and password fields.

6. Project Summary and Deliverables

CreatorSpace combines a creative portfolio interface with PHP application modules and a relational MySQL data model.

Component	Included in the project
Public website	Portfolio homepage, featured project cards, navigation, and project catalogue.
Accounts	Registration and login forms, password hashing, session handling, and email OTP verification logic.
Content management	Project records with categories, search/filter controls, and administrator-side project management code.
Dashboard and analytics	User dashboard module and administrator analytics built with Chart.js.
Database	MySQL tables for users, OTP verification records, projects, articles, and contact messages.
Documentation	README.md, ER_DIAGRAM.md, WIREFRAMES.md, and GitHub source repository.

Deployment and source

Live website: <https://creatorspace.infy.click>

GitHub repository: <https://github.com/Pavan-1080/creatorspace>

Project outcome

CreatorSpace demonstrates the organization of a full-stack portfolio application, from the public interface and PHP page structure to the relational data model and deployment setup. The source repository and supporting documentation provide a practical reference for the application's modules, schema, and navigation flow.

Conclusion

CreatorSpace Capstone

The project brings together a branded portfolio website, PHP and MySQL components, authentication and verification code, project catalogue controls, dashboard and administration modules, and supporting technical documentation in one capstone deliverable.